8A_Report_Preferences

1 Preferences (All Dimensions)

Takeaway: On average, HR shows little demographic preference, while Engineers display a stronger preference for non-White groups over White Males.

	Panel A: HR (Non-blind, N = 66)					Panel B: Engineer (Non-blind, N = 74)			
	sc_coding_z (1)	sc_fit_z (2)	sc_stay_z (3)	sc_overall_z (4)	sc_advance (5)	sc_coding_z (6)	sc_fit_z (7)	sc_stay_z (8)	sc_overall_z (9)
White Female	0.005	0.066	0.055	0.017	-0.017	0.043	0.015	0.029	0.060
	(0.084)	(0.087)	(0.091)	(0.079)	(0.044)	(0.049)	(0.071)	(0.085)	(0.052)
Asian Male	-0.015	0.034	0.117	0.003	0.003	0.144***	-0.015	0.050	0.104**
	(0.081)	(0.092)	(0.096)	(0.091)	(0.032)	(0.047)	(0.073)	(0.076)	(0.044)
Asian Female	0.018	0.075	0.042	0.060	0.010	0.081	0.163**	0.117	0.121**
	(0.082)	(0.080)	(0.092)	(0.081)	(0.034)	(0.050)	(0.065)	(0.081)	(0.048)
Hispanic Male	0.174**	0.124	0.169*	0.152*	0.037	0.068*	0.029	0.016	0.096**
	(0.087)	(0.087)	(0.086)	(0.084)	(0.038)	(0.040)	(0.055)	(0.066)	(0.039)
Hispanic Female	0.003	0.126	0.055	-0.048	-0.011	0.136***	0.172**	0.148	0.165***
	(0.097)	(0.105)	(0.117)	(0.094)	(0.043)	(0.045)	(0.067)	(0.094)	(0.050)
Observations	1,188	1,170	1,134	1,188	1,188	1,332	1,332	1,332	1,332
R^2	0.41323	0.31020	0.20001	0.43411	0.45460	0.81230	0.57737	0.37778	0.76371
Resume (Content) FE fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE fixed effects	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Standard errors clustered by respondent.\ Significance levels: * p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01

2 Heterogeneity in Preferences (By Respondent Demographics)

Takeaway: HR does not display preference based on demographic concordance. Engineers assign a slight premium (0.56–0.86% of a SD) to non-concordant groups, driven primarily by White Male Engineers — the majority group among Engineers — whose positive preference favors non-White demographic groups.

Takeaway (2): In the U.S. IT setting, the traditional concordance bias (homophily) and animus (discrimination against minorities) story can be rejected.

2.1 By Concordant Race (using detailed Asian categorization)

	Panel A: HR (Non-blind, N = 66)					Panel B: Engineer (Non-blind, N = 74)			
	sc_coding_z (1)	sc_fit_z (2)	sc_stay_z (3)	sc_overall_z (4)	sc_advance (5)	sc_coding_z (6)	sc_fit_z (7)	sc_stay_z (8)	sc_overall_z (9)
Concordant Race	0.030	0.016	0.060	0.043	0.014	-0.048	-0.065	-0.046	-0.062*
	(0.055)	(0.058)	(0.068)	(0.059)	(0.021)	(0.030)	(0.040)	(0.054)	(0.033)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	990	990	954	990	990	1,116	1,116	1,116	1,116
Adjusted R^2	0.33836	0.25613	0.13126	0.36664	0.38192	0.81497	0.59804	0.35506	0.75600

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

2.2 By Concordant Gender (includes Male / Female respondents only)

	Panel A: HR (Non-blind, N = 66)					Panel B: Engineer (Non-blind, N = 74)			
	sc_coding_z (1)	sc_fit_z (2)	sc_stay_z (3)	sc_overall_z (4)	sc_advance (5)	sc_coding_z (6)	sc_fit_z (7)	sc_stay_z (8)	sc_overall_z (9)
Concordant Gender	0.042	0.044	-0.020	0.023	0.007	-0.013	-0.068*	-0.068	-0.056*
	(0.052)	(0.057)	(0.066)	(0.053)	(0.025)	(0.026)	(0.039)	(0.060)	(0.032)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	1,134	1,116	1,080	1,134	1,134	1,278	1,278	1,278	1,278
Adjusted R^2	0.36354	0.25838	0.12807	0.37974	0.40982	0.78872	0.55103	0.32234	0.73762

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

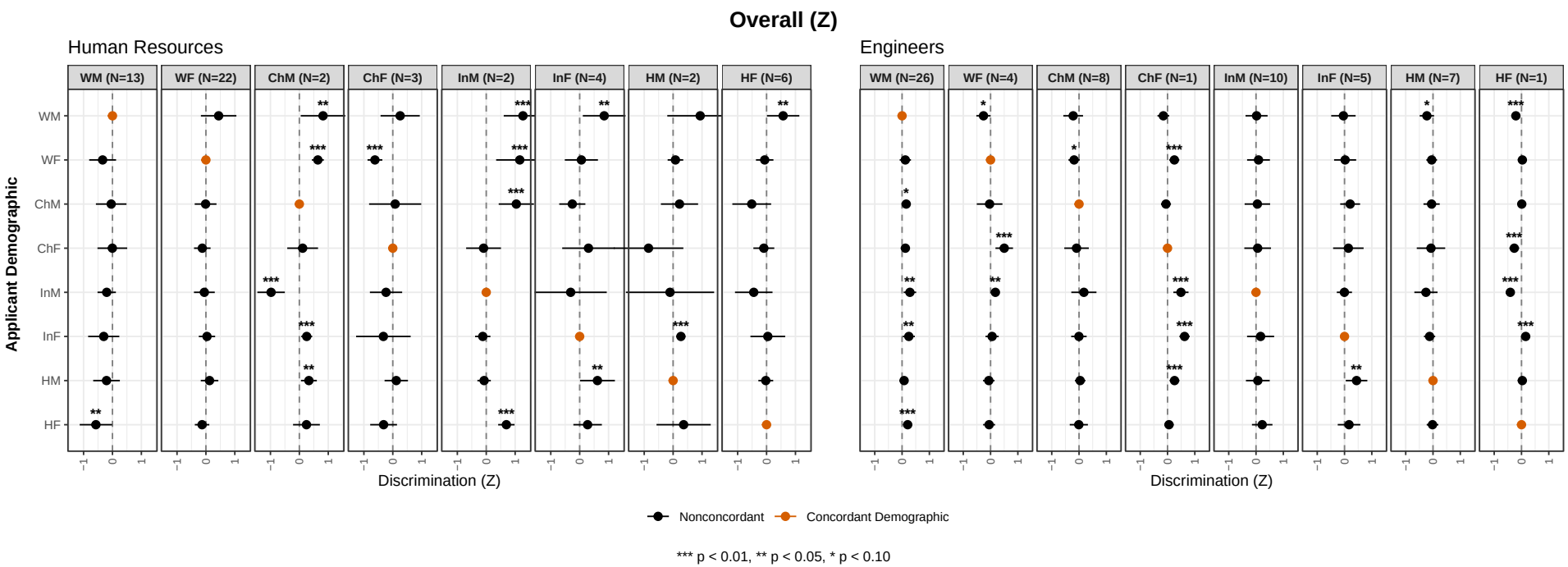
2.3 By Concordant Race and Gender (using detailed Asian categorization)

	Panel A: HR (Non-blind, N = 66)					Panel B: Engineer (Non-blind, N = 74)			
	sc_coding_z (1)	sc_fit_z (2)	sc_stay_z (3)	sc_overall_z (4)	sc_advance (5)	sc_coding_z (6)	sc_fit_z (7)	sc_stay_z (8)	sc_overall_z (9)
Concordant Race Gender	0.032	-0.020	-0.021	0.084	-0.008	-0.051	-0.071	-0.088	-0.087**
	(0.075)	(0.080)	(0.101)	(0.080)	(0.037)	(0.035)	(0.058)	(0.072)	(0.038)
Resume (Content) FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Display Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	972	972	936	972	972	1,116	1,116	1,116	1,116
Adjusted R^2	0.34291	0.25475	0.14292	0.37114	0.38470	0.81484	0.59818	0.35538	0.75616

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

2.3.1 Who drives Engineers' Bias Against Concordant Race Gender Groups

Below graph centers the concordant group.



3 Heterogeneity in Preferences (By Respondent DEI / Diversity Preferencs)

Takeaway: No individual DEI / diversity preference measure — stated, revealed, or firm-level — explains variation in demographic discrimination.

3.1 (2-way Interaction Models) By Individual DEI / Diversity Variables

Outcome Var: Assigned Overall Score (Z)

	Panel A: HR						Panel B: Engineer					
	Race DEI	Gender DEI	Diverse Wkpl	Div Goal	Firm Race Attn	Firm Gender Attn	Race DEI	Gender DEI	Diverse Wkpl	Div Goal	Firm Race Attn	Firm Gender Attn
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
White Female	0.019	0.019	0.019	0.018	0.0008	0.020	0.060	0.060	0.059	0.061	0.021	0.033
	(0.079)	(0.079)	(0.080)	(0.079)	(0.087)	(0.086)	(0.051)	(0.051)	(0.051)	(0.051)	(0.048)	(0.048)
Asian Male	0.005	0.005	0.004	0.003	0.004	0.022	0.103**	0.103**	0.105**	0.104**	0.093**	0.090*
	(0.091)	(0.092)	(0.092)	(0.090)	(0.089)	(0.090)	(0.044)	(0.044)	(0.043)	(0.044)	(0.046)	(0.048)
Asian Female	0.065	0.065	0.064	0.062	0.056	0.054	0.121**	0.121**	0.123**	0.121**	0.110**	0.105**
	(0.079)	(0.079)	(0.080)	(0.080)	(0.090)	(0.091)	(0.048)	(0.048)	(0.048)	(0.048)	(0.050)	(0.051)
Hispanic Male	0.155*	0.154*	0.152*	0.152*	0.142	0.156	0.098**	0.097**	0.098**	0.097**	0.089**	0.079*
	(0.084)	(0.084)	(0.085)	(0.084)	(0.091)	(0.097)	(0.039)	(0.039)	(0.039)	(0.038)	(0.044)	(0.043)
Hispanic Female	-0.051	-0.049	-0.048	-0.047	-0.103	-0.091	0.167***	0.168***	0.166***	0.166***	0.137**	0.141**
	(0.092)	(0.092)	(0.093)	(0.093)	(0.101)	(0.100)	(0.050)	(0.050)	(0.049)	(0.051)	(0.052)	(0.054)
White Female × Pro DEI/Diversity (Z)	0.117	0.130	0.114	0.029	0.012	0.119	-0.034	-0.077	-0.048	-0.079	-0.031	-0.009
	(0.088)	(0.096)	(0.102)	(0.081)	(0.093)	(0.095)	(0.072)	(0.066)	(0.077)	(0.052)	(0.062)	(0.058)
Asian Male × Pro DEI/Diversity (Z)	0.127	0.113	0.034	0.099	-0.121	0.0004	0.023	-0.016	-0.077*	-0.033	0.089**	0.018
	(0.103)	(0.109)	(0.112)	(0.084)	(0.093)	(0.088)	(0.035)	(0.039)	(0.040)	(0.039)	(0.044)	(0.044)
Asian Female × Pro DEI/Diversity (Z)	0.111	0.108	0.058	0.063	-0.022	0.031	0.008	-0.011	-0.029	-0.017	0.086	0.041
	(0.097)	(0.102)	(0.108)	(0.080)	(0.070)	(0.097)	(0.045)	(0.041)	(0.052)	(0.046)	(0.053)	(0.049)
Hispanic Male × Pro DEI/Diversity (Z)	0.084	0.064	0.015	0.057	-0.271***	-0.106	0.068	0.038	0.025	0.068	0.082	0.044
	(0.101)	(0.093)	(0.125)	(0.087)	(0.079)	(0.088)	(0.041)	(0.040)	(0.041)	(0.042)	(0.050)	(0.046)
Hispanic Female × Pro DEI/Diversity (Z)	0.232*	0.215*	0.180	0.149	-0.013	0.155	-0.014	-0.054	-0.088	-0.016	-0.034	-0.013
	(0.119)	(0.118)	(0.137)	(0.091)	(0.114)	(0.113)	(0.057)	(0.056)	(0.057)	(0.051)	(0.057)	(0.054)
Resume FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	1,188	1,188	1,188	1,188	1,026	1,008	1,332	1,332	1,332	1,332	1,098	1,080
Adjusted R^2	0.38152	0.38118	0.38073	0.37926	0.38128	0.37405	0.74201	0.74230	0.74262	0.74299	0.74675	0.74765

Standard errors clustered by respondent. Sample: non-blind arm.

Outcome Var: Assigned Overall Score (Z)

	Panel A: HR				Panel B: Engineer			
	DEI Views (R & G)	Diverse Wkpl	Div Goal	Firm DEI Attn (R & G)	DEI Views (R & G)	Diverse Wkpl	Div Goal	Firm DEI Attn (R & G)
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
URM (WF, AF, HM, HF)	0.049	0.049	0.049	0.028	0.059**	0.059**	0.059**	0.043
	(0.056)	(0.056)	(0.056)	(0.065)	(0.029)	(0.029)	(0.029)	(0.031)
URM × Pro DEI/Diversity (Z)	0.070	0.072	0.025	0.017	-0.007	0.006	0.009	0.002
	(0.061)	(0.072)	(0.051)	(0.065)	(0.032)	(0.036)	(0.029)	(0.037)
Resume FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	1,188	1,188	1,188	1,008	1,332	1,332	1,332	1,080
Adjusted R^2	0.37902	0.37906	0.37801	0.36675	0.74076	0.74076	0.74077	0.74752

3.2 (2-way Interaction Models) By Whether the Firm Targets the Same Applicant Demographic

Takeaway: When a firm states it targets a demographic, its individual evaluators rate applicants of that group *lower*, not higher — more strongly among engineers than among HR. This mirrors the substitution pattern documented in Section 3.3: where institutional DEI effort is high, individual evaluators appear to ease off from the institutional push.

Firm Targets × Same Applicant Demographic (s5_policy_diversity)

	Panel A: HR	Panel B: Engineer
	(1)	(2)
White Female	-0.048	0.084
	(0.095)	(0.051)
Asian Male	0.005	0.112**
	(0.092)	(0.045)
Asian Female	0.003	0.153***
	(0.091)	(0.051)
Hispanic Male	0.157*	0.109***
	(0.085)	(0.040)
Hispanic Female	-0.107	0.201***
	(0.113)	(0.049)
Applicant Male × Firm Targets Male	-0.206**	-0.003
	(0.098)	(0.106)
Applicant Female × Firm Targets Female	0.095	-0.348**
	(0.236)	(0.174)
Applicant Asian × Firm Targets Asian	-0.151*	-0.261**
	(0.084)	(0.099)
Applicant Hispanic × Firm Targets Hispanic	-0.034	-0.209**
	(0.142)	(0.100)
Resume FE	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓
Position FE	✓	✓
Observations	1,188	1,332
Adjusted R^2	0.38011	0.74387

URM-Tech Binary Cut × Combined Firm-Target Dummy

	Panel A: HR		Panel B: Engineer	
	Targets F or H	Targets F, H, or B	Targets F or H	Targets F, H, or B
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
URM (WF, AF, HM, HF)	0.013	0.013	0.070**	0.057**
	(0.060)	(0.060)	(0.029)	(0.027)
URM × Firm Targets URM	0.170	0.170	-0.160	0.019
	(0.160)	(0.160)	(0.111)	(0.185)
Resume FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	1,188	1,188	1,332	1,332
Adjusted R^2	0.37901	0.37901	0.74114	0.74076

F = Female, H = Hispanic, B = Black. "Targets F or H" ⇒ `firm_targets_female = 1` OR `firm_targets_hispanic = 1`; "Targets F, H, or B" additionally includes `firm_targets_black = 1` (robustness check; note that Black applicants are not in the study). URM = {WF, AF, HM, HF}.

3.3 (Triple Interaction Models) By Respondent's Priority for DEI × Firm Attention on DEI

Takeaway: The negative triple interactions for HR (with both race-DEI and gender-DEI firm-attention proxies) support the **substitution** hypothesis, not backlash.

Hypothesis: **Substitution vs. Backlash Effect.**

- **Substitution**: When a firm already prioritizes DEI, individuals who *also* personally prioritize DEI reduce (rather than amplify) the URM premium — they treat the firm's push as sufficient and ease off. *Expect a negative sign on the triple interaction term.*
- **Backlash**: When a firm prioritizes DEI, individuals who do *not* personally prioritize DEI react by rating URM applicants lower. *Expect a positive sign on the triple interaction term.*

Outcome Var: Assigned Overall Score (Z). URM-Tech Binary Cut.

	Firm Race-DEI Attn		**Firm Gender-DEI Attn**	
	HR	Eng	HR	Eng
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
URM (WF, AF, HM, HF)	0.048	0.056	0.058	0.053
	(0.062)	(0.035)	(0.067)	(0.033)
URM × Respondent Prioritizes Diversity	0.058	0.030	0.057	0.025
	(0.050)	(0.035)	(0.052)	(0.035)
URM × Firm DEI Attn	-0.021	-0.024	0.003	-2.89×10^{-5}
	(0.060)	(0.042)	(0.067)	(0.036)
URM × Respondent Prioritizes Diversity × Firm DEI Attn	-0.111**	-0.059	-0.102*	-0.047
	(0.042)	(0.036)	(0.054)	(0.031)
Resume FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondent FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Position FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Respondents (used)	57	61	56	60
Dropped (NA proxy)	9	13	10	14
Observations	1,026	1,098	1,008	1,080
Adjusted R^2	0.37300	0.74422	0.36822	0.74760

`div_priority_z` = z-score of (8 − `s4_goals_5`), the revealed priority of "Diversity and Representation" in the respondent's ranking of seven hiring goals. `firm_attention_race_z` / `firm_attention_gender_z` = z-scores of `s5_view_dei_race_f` / `s5_view_dei_gender_f`, the respondent's perception of their firm's current DEI attention level. Standard errors clustered by respondent. Sample: non-blind arm; respondents with a missing firm-DEI-attention response are dropped by `feols` (see the `Respondents (used)''` and`Dropped (NA proxy)''` rows).

Note on interpretation: On the full non-blind Engineer sample (all 74 respondents), a two-way model `sc_overall_z ~ urm_tech | responseid + resume_index + r_do_bythree` reports a statistically significant $\hat{\beta}_{\text{URM}} = +0.060$ ($p = .041$). It attenuates to statistically insignificant $\hat{\beta} \approx +0.040$ in the triple-model subsample for two reasons: (a) ≈ 18% of Engineers are dropped due to answering "Do Not Know'' in the question that elicits how much firm pays attentions to DEI, and (b) these dropped respondents happen to rate URM applicants more favorably than respondents who did characterize their firm's DEI posture.

Reading the HR Overall regression at $\pm 1\sigma$ of each covariate (for Hispanic Male applicants, vs White Male), the four quadrants give the most direct picture of the substitution mechanism:

Table 1: Predicted Hispanic Male premium (vs. White Male) on HR Overall rating, at quadrants of (personal diversity priority $\times$ firm race-DEI attention).

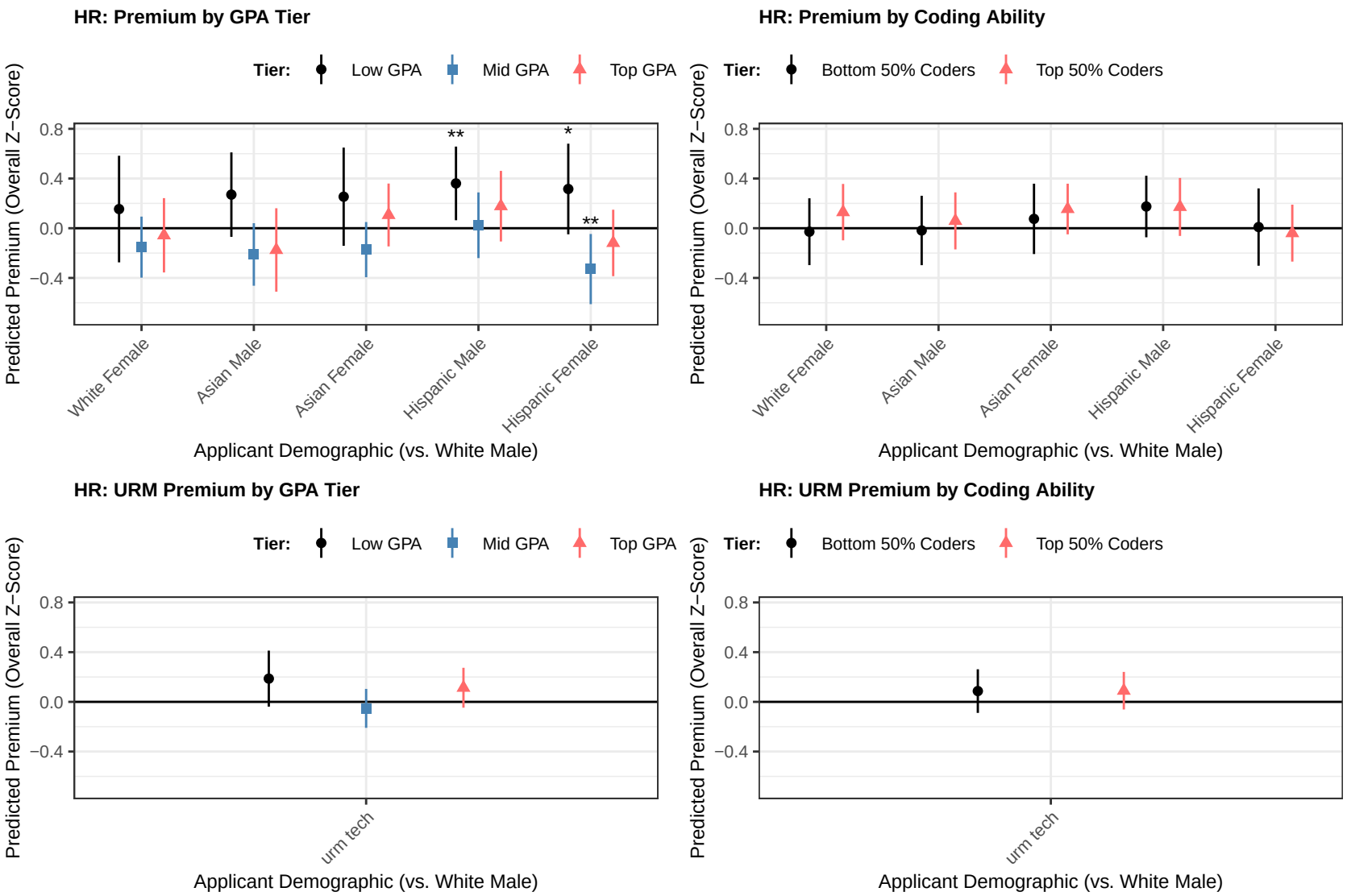
	Firm Race-DEI Attention	
	Low Firm Race Attn	High Firm Race Attn
Low personal priority (-1σ)	+0.19	-0.11
High personal priority ($+1\sigma$)	+0.74	-0.15

The largest HM premium ($+0.74\sigma$) sits in the (high personal priority, low firm attention) cell — the "individual compensates for firm inattention" case. At firms already emphasizing race-DEI (right column), HM premia collapse regardless of personal priority. The backlash quadrant (low personal priority, high firm attention) is modestly negative, not extreme.

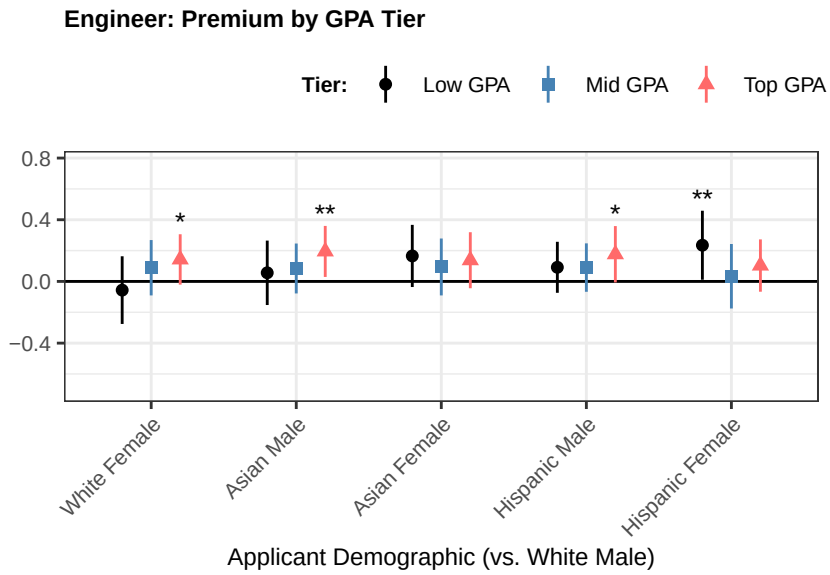
Implication: Neither stated DEI attitudes nor observable firm DEI behaviors, taken singly, explain variation in demographic premia. However, the combination of strong personal diversity priority and a firm that does not visibly act on it is associated with a substantially larger Hispanic-Male premium among HR evaluators — a pattern consistent with individual-level substitution for perceived firm inattention, rather than backlash against firm over-emphasis.

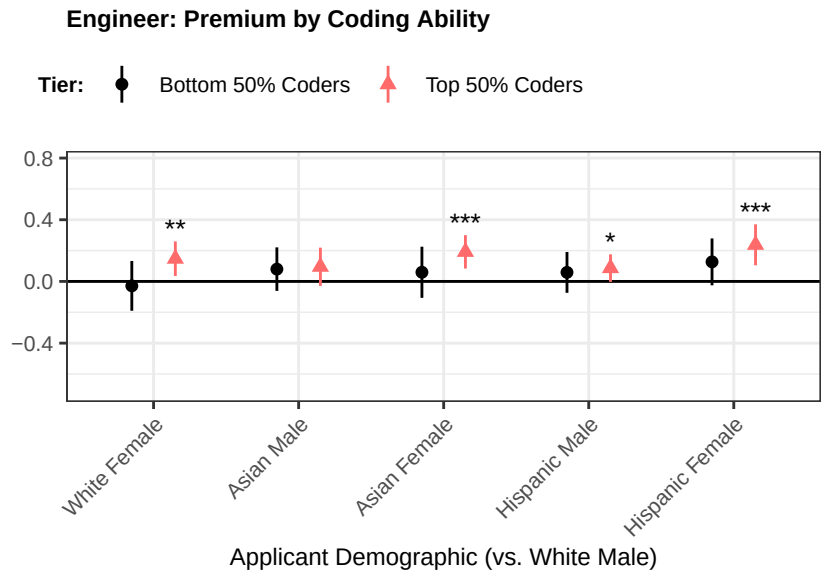
3.4 Non-linear Demographic Biases for Low vs High Quality Candidates (GPA & Coding Score)

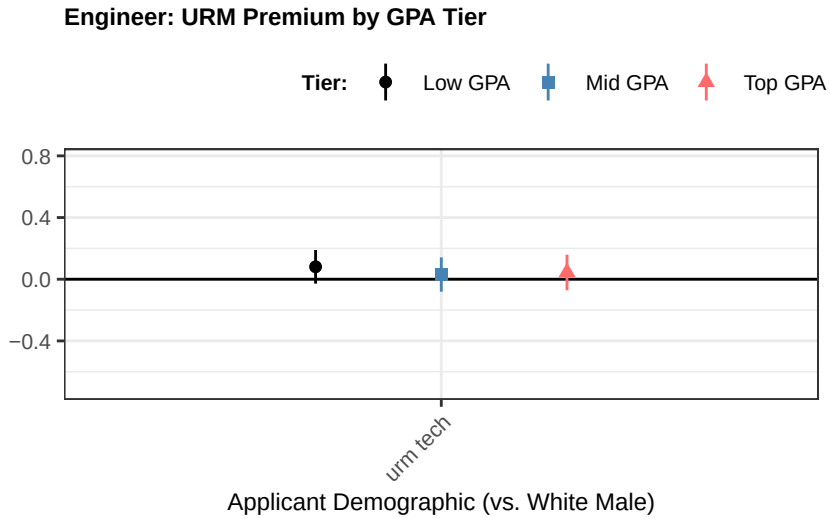
3.4.0.1 HR

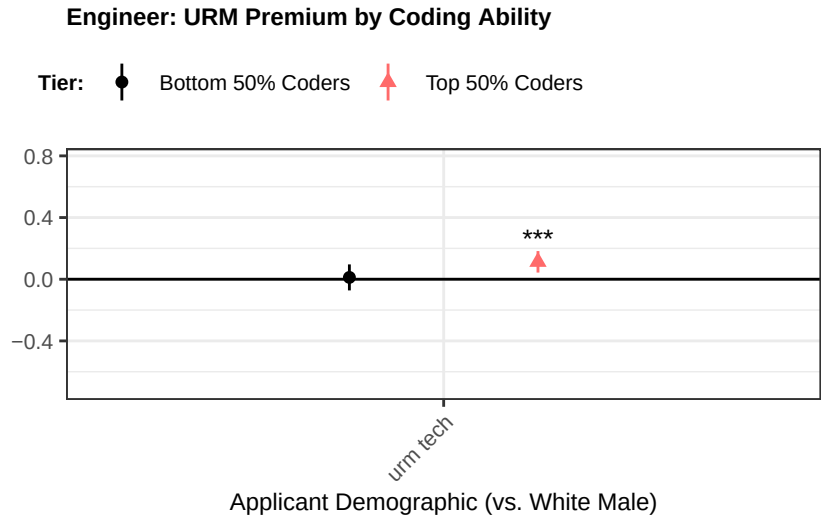


3.4.0.2 Engineer







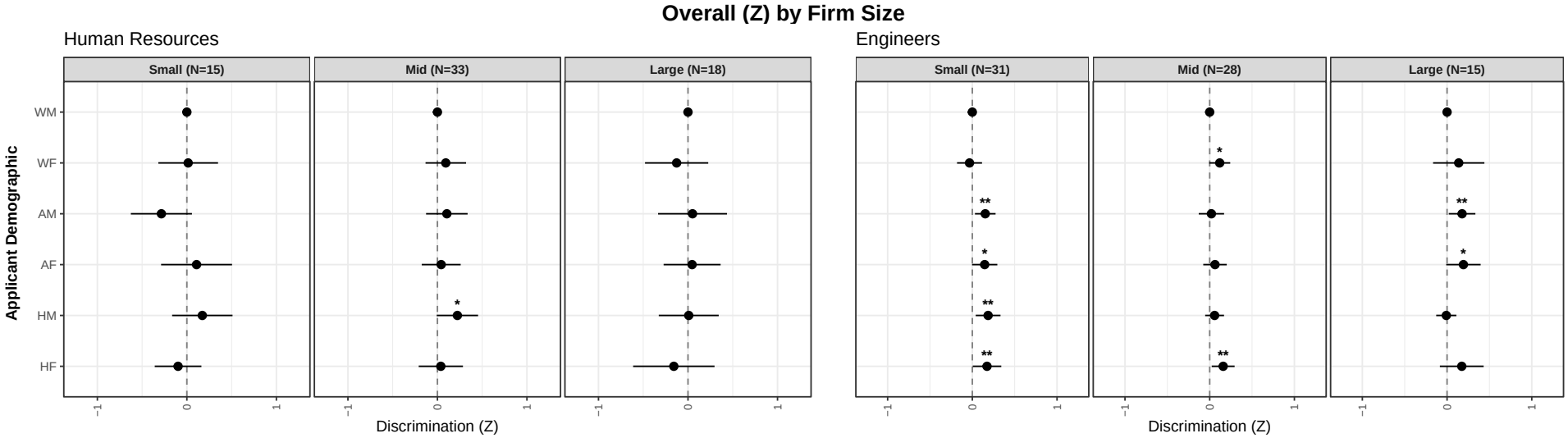


(Eng) Signal from GPA vs Coding Test

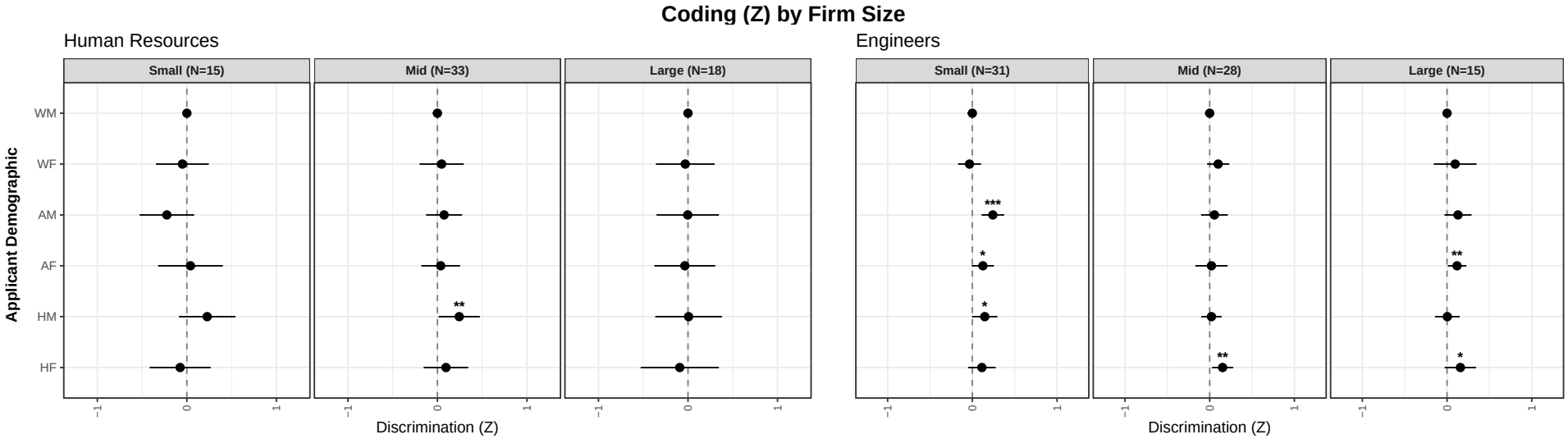
	sc_overall_z (1)
URM	0.058**
	(0.029)
URM × Coding Score (Z)	0.094**
	(0.040)
URM × GPA (Z)	-0.094**
	(0.044)
Observations	1,332
Adjusted R^2	0.74228
Resume FE	✓
Respondent FE	✓
Position FE	✓

Standard errors clustered by respondent. Sample restricted to non-blind condition, Engineer role.

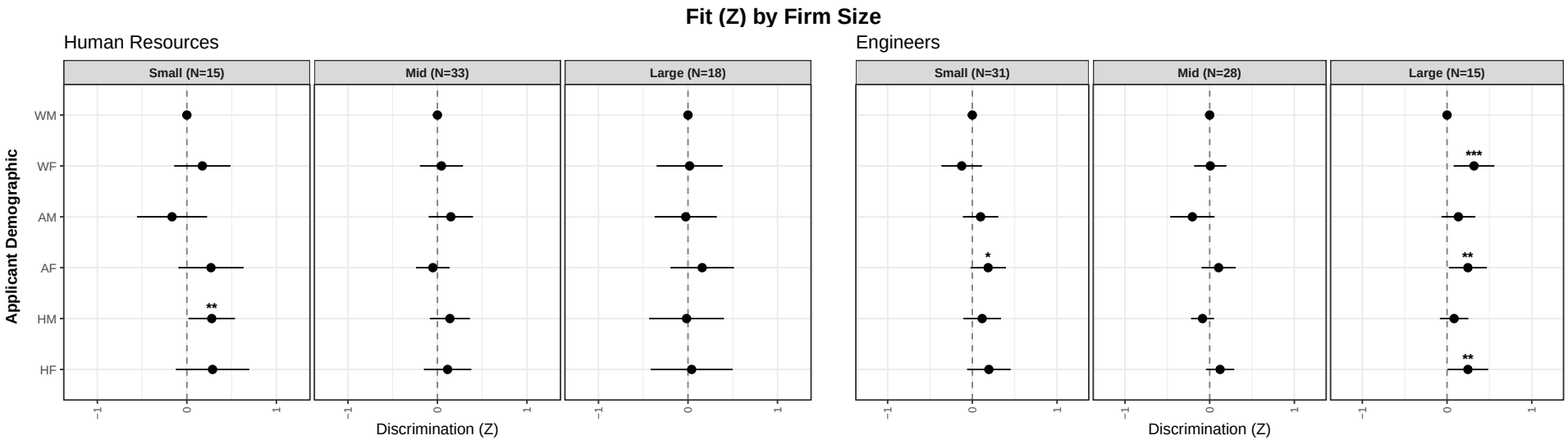
3.5 Heterogeneity by Firm Size



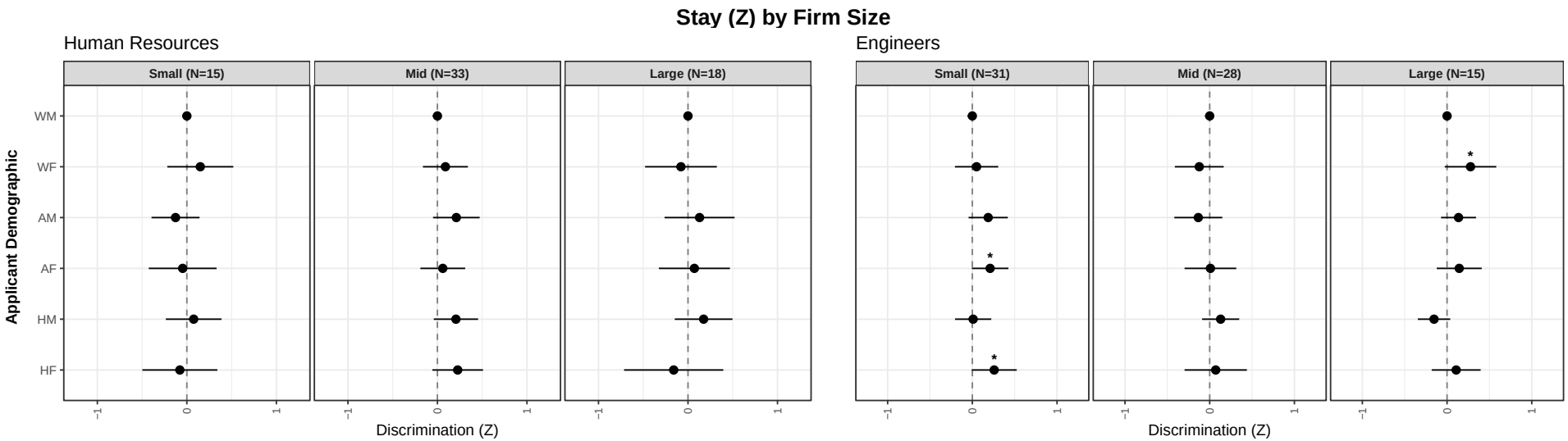
*** p < 0.01, ** p < 0.05, * p < 0.10



*** p < 0.01, ** p < 0.05, * p < 0.10



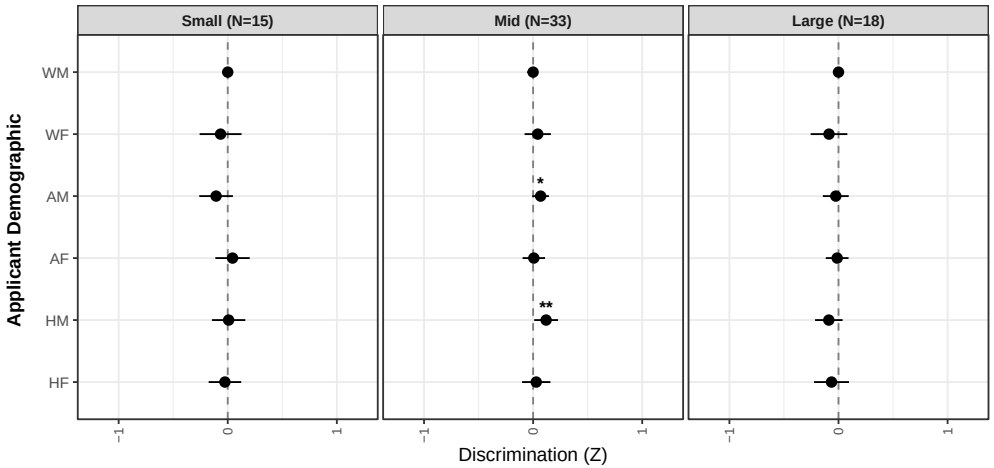
*** p < 0.01, ** p < 0.05, * p < 0.10



*** p < 0.01, ** p < 0.05, * p < 0.10

Advance (0/1, LPM) by Firm Size

Human Resources



Engineers: Not Measured

*** p < 0.01, ** p < 0.05, * p < 0.10